

Preface

Beary-Kannada-English Lexicon, which Karnataka Beary Sahitya Academy is bringing out, is a major event in the history of the studies in minority languages. Beary language is spoken by Bearys, a community of Muslims in the southern parts of the west coast of Karnataka with Mangalore as its centre, besides Kasargod in Kerala. Although several writings and books have come out on the community and the language it speaks, no serious study has been undertaken on either of them. No fieldwork worth the name had been undertaken in the areas where that language is spoken nor any regional survey been attempted in a purposive way. That is why the richness of that spoken language had not been unveiled. It meant that the grammar of Beary language, or for that matter, the question as to which linguistic lineage the language belonged remained in the realm of speculation. It is against this background that I think the publication of *Beary-Kannada-English Lexicon* becomes very significant and that it is likely to become a valuable source book for the study of that language.

The editors of the Lexicon, Prof. B.M. Ichlangod, B.A. Shamshuddin Madikeri, and Abdul Rahman Kuthethoor, have written, in their Introduction, about the making of Dictionary. It needs no retelling. The salient features of the Lexicon may be summarised thus: In the first of the four columns would figure Beary word in Kannada script; in the second, their transliteration in Roman script; in the third, the meaning/s of the original Beary word in Kannada; and in the fourth, the meaning/s of the original Beary word in English.

Beary language is largely a language of Karnataka. The making of the Lexicon was made possible because the Government of Karnataka established Karnataka Beary Sahitya Academy. Bearys of Karnataka are able to read and write Kannada well. Their contribution to modern Kannada literature is, in fact, considerable. That explains why the contemporary Beary writings

are available only in Kannada script. Hence Beary words figure first in the Dictionary, and in Kannada script. However, many in the Beary community have moved out of Kannada-speaking areas in search of jobs or in pursuit of trade. There are many among them who cannot read Kannada script, but they speak the Beary language. They are able to read what is written in Roman script, though. We have, therefore, given in the second column, the transliteration of Beary words in Roman script. As they do in languages using Roman script, we have indicated pronunciation signs through diacritical marks. We have used some special signs to indicate special pronunciations in the Beary tongue. We have given the details separately for the users of the dictionary. On the third column the meaning/s of Beary words have been given in Kannada language and script. If the word has more than one meaning, they are indicated by numbers 1, 2, 3 and so on. On the fourth column you will find meaning/s in English, taking into account the words in Beary language and their meaning/s in Kannada. There is no grammar book as yet for the Beary language, and since this is the first lexical venture in that language we have not given all the grammatical features of Beary words in the dictionary. Here only nouns and verbs are indicated. Pronoun, adjective, adverb, interjections or derivatives which bring out the grammatical contours of a word have been left out. Other suffixes indicating number and gender get indicated in the words, though. These strategies are both unique and incomplete in this dictionary, but we have to resort to them owing to the handicap that the editors had to begin and sustain the project with. This also underlines the need for revamping the editorial strategies when the Lexicon is revised next.

An explanation is necessary for the ways in which Beary words are gathered and included in this dictionary. The people who participated in all the meetings in connection with the dictionary, including the President of the Academy and the three distinguished members of the Editorial Board are native speakers of Beary language and are eminently equipped to understand the scope, opulence of Beary vocabulary and the nuances of their usage. They were of the opinion that since people of the Beary community are involved in different vocations and professions and they routinely use the words in different spheres of activities such as education, science, technology, administration, legal profession, medical profession and so on. Though borrowed, these words are commonly used in Beary language. That is why they have not been referred to as foreign words but as Beary words.

When dictionaries are taken up as long-term projects, it is common to find in them a good practice of illustrating the use of words or phrases in ways in which they figure in a sentence. But since this is a short-term project of two and half years, we could not include illustrating the words used in a sentence, which otherwise would have added to the richness and utility of the work. But such a task can certainly be undertaken when the Lexicon is taken up for revision.

We visualise the following uses of this Beary-Kannada-English Dictionary:

For the native speakers of Beary language:

1. They can retrieve the Beary words rendered irrelevant by the onslaught of modernity and use them wherever possible and useful.
2. The writers and poets who wish to cultivate Beary language can draw from this Lexicon and use words and phrases to enrich that language.
3. Those who lecture in Beary language in different contexts and on different subjects can profitably use this dictionary to augment their vocabulary.
4. This Lexicon will come in handy when children of Beary community are introduced to teaching in Beary language.
5. Those Bearys who are no longer in Karnataka and are unfamiliar with the Kannada script can use the transliteration in Roman script available in the dictionary, find the meanings and use them to teach the language to those who do not know it.

From the point of view of studying the Beary language:

1. The Lexicon will help establishing the fact that Beary language has an identity of its own.
2. This will help in putting together a grammar book for Beary language, which is its desideratum.
3. Those who know Kannada can attempt learning Beary language by connecting Beary words with their meanings given in Kannada.
4. Even the non-Bearies and non-Kannadigas can use the transliteration of Beary words in Roman script and go to their meanings given in English and gain access to the Beary language.

From the linguistic point of view:

1. It will help the linguists to compare the Beary language with other languages to decide to which language group it should belong.
2. The Lexicon will facilitate a better study of the phonetics and structure of Beary language as well as richness and limitations of its vocabulary.
3. It can help in tracing the origins of the words that have entered the Beary language and research into them may open out a new world of historical and social interactions. In fact, many words which are in use in Beary language are common to those in many other languages too, which testifies to its receptive character. Words from Tulu, Kannada, Tamil, Malayalam, Arabic, Persian, Kodava and many other languages can found in abundance in Beary language. This will

beckon scholars to a rewarding comparative research which will possibly throw light on the making of the Beary language as well as the formation of the Beary community.

4. The dictionary will be an aid to the exploration of the interactive life of the people of various linguistic groups in the Mangalore region like Tulu, Kannada, Konkani and others.

5. Socio-Linguistic study may throw light on the interactions among vocational groups, religious and linguistic communities, which will enable us to understand the social fabric of the region better.

A note by way of gratitude:

The person who made this Lexicon project possible is the President of Karnataka Beary Sahitya Academy, B.A. Mohammad Hanif. It is his commitment, efficiency and time-bound planning which are instrumental in bringing out this Dictionary within a short time of three years. Starting with the selection of the editors, he was actively involved in organising meetings, collecting and collating opinions, sharing his own experiences and honouring the wisdom of scholars, and he altogether pursued the mission with the same religious passion as he would adhere to the fast of Holy Ramzan. Whenever I could not attend the meeting at the office of the Academy he would hold the meeting in my residence, along with the members of the editorial committee. To these courtesies and efficient management of affairs, I record my appreciation and gratitude to the President. At the administrative level the then Registrar of the Academy, Umarabba has extended his cooperation in full measure.

The Editor of the Lexicon, Prof. B.M. Ichlangod, a learned teacher of history and a researcher of repute, has been a main source of strength and the Dictionary has benefited greatly from his scholarship and hard work. He was superbly assisted by the two Co-Editors, poet and writer B.A. Shamshuddin Madikeri and Abdul Rahman Kuthethoor. In fact, these two, along with the Editor formed the Triumvirate who saw the project through. I have seen them pursuing the project with a religious commitment. They never hesitated in accepting whatever meaningful suggestions that came from the advisory committee. They made no distinction between insiders and outsiders when it came to exchange of views, and I have always found discussions with them refreshing and invigorating. In the Advisory Committee I had the senior scholar in linguistics and the editor of the multi-volume Tulu Dictionary, Dr. U.P. Upadhyaya, Prof. A.V. Navada, a renowned scholar and researcher in Kannada, Tulu, literature and folklore and B.M. Hanif, a well-known journalist and a literary figure in Beary language. Their participation in the Advisory Committee was most rewarding. The one who has provided the English meaning/s to the Beary words in the Dictionary is Prof. B. Surendra Rao, a retired Professor of History of Mangalore University and a person who has been, of late, involved in translation projects. A man of keen interest in English, he has recently figured in the translation of Tulu poems into English and won appreciation. Regularly keeping in touch with the editors, he has been able to grasp the nuances of Beary words and give them the

right possible meanings in English, so as to draw the attention of international scholars to the project.

If this Lexicon attracts the attention of the speakers and users of Beary language and if they can harness it to explore new ideas and undertake new research, the labour of its editors would not go in vain. The critical attention that people can give to this dictionary should also equip them to give the right kinds of suggestion for its improvement when it comes up for revision.

A note on the pronunciation of Beary words used in the Dictionary:

The phonetics of the Beary language, the nature of their transliteration and the scientific ways of pronouncing the words have been given

Phonology of Beary Language

The phonemic system of Byari Language is as follows :

VOWELS:	Front	Central	Back
	ಇ ಈ		ಉ ಊ
High:	<i>i ī</i>	<i>ɨ</i>	<i>u ū</i>
	ಎ ಏ		ಒ ಓ
Mid:	<i>e ē</i>		<i>o ō</i>
			ಅ ಆ
Low:	ಏ		<i>a ā</i>

Based on the part of the tongue raised or lowered , the vowels are sub-classified as 'Front' 'Central' and 'Back'. Based on the height to which the tongue is raised or lowered , vowels are sub-classified as 'High' 'Mid' and 'Low'. Based on the lip position , vowels are sub-classified as 'Rounded' and 'Unrounded'

Rounded Vowels: *u ū, ɨ, o ō*

Unrounded Vowels: *i ī, e ē, a ā*

CONSONANTS:	Voiceless	Voiced	Nasals
	ಕ್	ಗ್	ಜ್
Velar:	<i>k</i>	<i>g</i>	<i>ŋ</i>
	ಚ್	ಜ್	ಞ್
Palatal:	<i>c</i>	<i>j</i>	<i>ɲ</i>
	ಟ್	ಡ್	ಣ್
Retroflex:	<i>ʈ</i>	<i>ɖ</i>	<i>ɳ</i>
	ತ್	ದ್	ನ್ ನ್
Dental:	<i>t</i>	<i>d</i>	<i>n n'</i>
	ಪ್	ಬ್	ಮ್
Labial:	<i>p</i>	<i>b</i>	<i>m</i>

Velar consonants are pronounced with back part of the tongue against soft palate, which is back part of the mouth.

Glottal consonants are formed by the audible release of the airstream after complete closure of glottis.

Palatal consonants are pronounced with the middle part of the tongue against the hard palate (middle part of the roof of the mouth.)

Dental consonants are articulated with the tongue against the upper teeth.

Retroflex consonants are produced when the tongue has flat, or even curled shape, and is articulated between the alveolar ridge and the hard palate.

Labial consonants are produced by the articulation of one or both the lips.

Alveolar consonants are produced with the tongue close to or touching the ridge behind the teeth on the roof of the mouth.

Consonants - Unclassified

ಯ	ರ	ಲ	ವ	ಶ	ಸ	ಹ
<i>y</i>	<i>r</i>	<i>l</i>	<i>v</i>	<i>ś</i>	<i>s</i>	<i>h</i>

y : voiced palatal

r : voiced alveolar

l : voiced alveolar

v : voiced labio-dental

ś : voiceless palatal

s : voiceless alveolar

h : voiced glottal

kh : aspirated voiceless velar

jh (like 'z' in English) : dental-alveolar

ph (like 'f' in English) : voiceless labio-dental fricative

n' : voiced alveolar

Anusvara : 'o'

Anusvara in Kannada script is represented by the symbol 'o'. Transliteration of Anusvara 'o' in Roman script is substituted by the corresponding nasals related to the group to which that particular

nasal belongs . For unclassified consonants , the nasal 'm' is substituted . The details are given below:

ñ before *k* and *g* . Can be for *kh*.

ñ before *c* and *j* . Can be for *jh*.

ṇ before *ṭ* and *ḍ*

n and *n'* before *t* and *d*

m before *p* , *b* , *y* , *r* , *l* , *v* , *ś* , *s* and *h*. Can be for *ph* .

Beary Language: Pronunciation of the Alphabets in Transliteration

Roman Transliteration	Nearest English equivalent in pronunciation
<i>a</i>	u of 'cut'
<i>ā</i>	a of 'calm'
<i>i</i>	i of 'sit'
<i>ī</i>	ee of 'keep'
<i>u</i>	u of 'put'
<i>ū</i>	oo of 'shoot'
<i>ε</i>	e of 'men'
<i>e</i>	e of 'bet'
<i>ē</i>	a of 'mate'
<i>o</i>	o of 'obey'
<i>ō</i>	o of 'note'
<i>k</i>	k of 'kitchen'
<i>g</i>	g of 'good'
<i>ñ</i>	ng of 'sing'
<i>c</i>	ch of 'chicken'
<i>j</i>	j of 'joke'
<i>ñ</i>	n of 'bench'
<i>ṭ</i>	t of 'neat'(see note below)
<i>ḍ</i>	d of 'day'(see note below)

<i>ŋ</i>	No equivalent in English (see note below)
<i>n'</i>	n of 'synthetic' or 'anthem'
<i>t</i>	th of 'thief'
<i>d</i>	th of 'they'
<i>n</i>	n of 'name'
<i>p</i>	p of 'police'
<i>b</i>	b of 'body'
<i>m</i>	m of 'mother'
<i>y</i>	y of 'yard'
<i>r</i>	r of 'ring'
<i>l</i>	l of 'love'
<i>v</i>	v of 'victory'
<i>ś</i>	sh of 'shame'
<i>s</i>	s of 'song'
<i>h</i>	h of 'hand'
<i>kh</i>	No equivalent in English. In Arabic kh in 'Khalifa.'
<i>jh</i>	z of 'zero'
<i>ph</i>	f of 'father'

Note: In Beary language **t̤, d̤, ŋ** are retroflex phonemes. In pronouncing retroflex phonemes, the tip of the tongue is curled back. There are no retroflex phonemes in English language. So no English equivalents in pronunciation for such retroflex phonemes can be found. However, in pronouncing 't̤' and 'd̤', the examples of 'neat' and 'day' are given, which are somewhat nearer, but not exact.

Prof. B.A. Viveka Rai

Few Words from the Member Secretary

Beary language, one of the languages of the Dravidian family, is said to have a long history of over fifteen hundred years. Though it has remained a spoken language, it is significant that it is yet the mother tongue of over fifteen lakhs of people.

Karnataka Beary Sahitya Academy was formed with the lofty purpose of highlighting and promoting this unique language in the Kannada land, its literary facets and cultural opulence. Right from its inception, the Academy has organised several programmes and taken up several projects to realise these aims. It has organised many seminars; it has published several works in Beary language on short stories, poems, novels, biographies, children's literature, research articles and papers of serious intellectual dimensions and import. It has organised not only the Poets' Meet in Beary language but also of other sister languages. It has held many competitions to attract the speakers and users of Beary language. For 2015-16 it has offered six Beary fellowships for those engaged in research on Beary language and culture. Recently the Academy has brought out a volume about one hundred poems in Beary language. Ever since the present President took charge of the Academy, it has been meaningfully organising the Beary Language Day.

The Beary language has to grow further as a language of literature and education. Realising that to preserve and augment the immense riches of its vocabulary and bequeath them to posterity, the present team of Beary Sahitya Academy, consisting of its President, Members and the Registrar had resolved upon bringing out a Beary Lexicon three years ago. That it was important to collect its word riches of what is essentially a spoken language, giving their meanings in Kannada and English to help the speakers and non-speakers of Beary language alike was the dream of the President Janab B.A. Mohammad Hanif, who spared no effort to realise it in the course of these three years. As the Chief Editor of the Lexicon project, he was the guiding light to the Editors, the Editorial Board and the Advisory Committee, whose unremitting labour and unflagging enthusiasm has produced this significant work. This Lexicon, we hope, will be of immense use not only to those who use Beary language

but also to those students and researchers who undertake a comparative and analytical study of languages that flourish in this country.

The Academy has to express its gratitude and thank all those who made possible this significant project. It wishes to record its thanks to the Government of Karnataka, its Honourable Chief Minister, the Minister of Kannada and Culture, the Chief Secretary of the Department of Kannada and Culture, its Director and Joint Director and all the officials and personnel of the Department, the Members of the Academy and the personnel working there. The Academy also expresses its appreciation and thanks to the “Digantha Mudranalaya”, Mangaluru, its proprietor and personnel, for the prompt and neat printing of the Lexicon.

We are aware that the Academy has to undertake many programmes and projects for the promotion of the Beary language and culture. It is confident that it would undertake them with the generous assistance and support of the Karnataka Government. We also hope that we will not be lacking in active and valuable support from all in society.

June 2017

Umarabba
Member Secretary
Editorial Board

Editorial

Beary language is one of the flourishing languages on the west coast, in the districts of Dakshina Kannada, Udupi in Karnataka and Kasargod in Kerala, and is said to belong to the Dravidian family of languages. Like Tulu, Konkani and Kodava, it is one of the sister languages of Kannada.

Beary language has, however, retained its own identity. Although it has borrowed some Arabic words, they have not been in any way decisive in the making of the Beary culture. They have influenced the formation of religious and cultural idioms, no doubt. Trade, which connected the Arabs with the indigenous Beary community, naturally left such a stamp, but it is incorrect to conclude that it created a new language or spawned a culture that is Arab-centric. But there is no gainsaying that since the religion of Bearys is drawn from the Arabs, many words associated with Islam and its practices have been tenanted the Beary language. It has also borrowed words and from Tamil, Tulu, Malayalam and Kannada to grow into a rich language. Many scholars subscribe to the view that Beary language is an independent Dravidian language. (*Beary Bhashe Dravida Bhasheye?* by Prof. B.M. Ichlangod; *Malayaala Bhashe Mattu Sahitya*, by Dr Susheela Upadhyaya and Dr U.P. Upadhyaya).

Bearys are followers of Islam and their culture and practices are unique in many ways. Though the Beary language can claim a history of over 1500 years, it has remained a spoken language of a community and its writing or literature remained uncultivated, which ensured that the progress of the language got largely stunted. But that it had its rich folk literature is testified by the folktales collected by Dr Susheela Upadhyaya (*Beary Bhashe* by Dr Susheela Upadhyaya). In the absence of a well-cultivated and sturdy literary tradition, the oral tradition in which Beary folklore or literature was couched went out of use and circulation.

We have to acknowledge that Arabic-Malayalam, a language which used Arabic script, which once had considerable popularity, had considerable influence on Beary language and culture. *Maalepaattu*, *Kissapaattu*, *Sebinapaattu* and others, which were written in Arabic-Malayalam script, had their influence on Beary language too, since they constituted parts of popular Beary folklore. They have supplied many words to Beary language and enriched it. Many folktales, songs, riddles and adages in Arabic-Malayalam centre around Islam, and we are able to see their influence on Beary language. Even when

one concedes it, there is no gainsaying that the Beary lifestyle which is based on their vocations, trade and agriculture has largely gone into the making of Beary language and preserving it over the centuries. Their independent lifestyle has also contributed to the identity of that language.

Although there are records in 'Batteluthu' script, which the Bearys are said to have used once, we cannot say anything with confidence about the cultivation and growth of Beary language and literature in them. That is an area which is crying out for researchers' labour. But what is indisputable is that Beary language was cultivated and used in Arabic-Malayalam and that Bearys have indeed considerably contributed to this mixed linguistic cultivation. Although the Bearys and their culture are rooted in the Tulunadu region, trade and employment have carried this community outside, to the other parts of the state and country and to the countries beyond. This and the researches of Dr Susheela Upadhyaya, Prof. B.M. Ichlangod, Dr. Wahab Doddamane, Ahmed Noori and others have kindled new interest in Beary community, language and culture.

In recent years, that too since 2008 when Karnataka Beary Sahitya Academy came into existence, there has been an official recognition to Beary language, and it is no exaggeration to say that it has given considerable fillip to the promotion of Beary language and culture. But for the establishment of the Academy such a massive project as the making of the Beary Lexicon would not have been undertaken nor would the Lexicon have seen the light of the day. Not much work has been done on Beary language and for those who undertake such work this Lexicon would surely be of some assistance. For, it unveils a picture, or at least snapshots, of Beary language and culture.

Although Beary language has its own identity, harrowing influence of alien cultures prevented its free growth and for the last eighty decades, it has remained languid and shorn of its dynamism. Now there is a revival of interest in Beary language and it is heartening to see many literary forms in that language finding expressions both in their making and publication. Writers of short stories, poems, novels as well as those writing on children's tales, plays and biographies have become active and are becoming more and more productive. Writers are also turning their attention to environment, science and such other themes. It is noteworthy that cassettes and CDs on Beary songs are coming out in their thousands and many journals and magazines are also been published.

Seen from the point of view of culture, religion, art, trade and agriculture, it is evident that Beary language has a rich storehouse of vocabulary and phrases. Many vocations that people practice, rituals and festivals, beliefs and practices, arts and music, plays and games and other aspects of Beary lifestyles have joyously entered into Beary vocabulary, which can match other languages in its plenitude and richness. This would help in making a comparative study of other cognate Dravidian languages. Some scholars also feel that this would enable us to reconstruct the original form of the Beary language. The work of the Beary Lexicon has been undertaken with these hopes and goals in mind.

Bearys have been using the Kannada script for Beary language. For, besides their own language, they have been using Kannada as transactional and educational language. Kannada script is clearly and comfortably acceptable to Beary language. It has also ensured a close bond between Beary and Kannada languages. It is also noteworthy that Bearys have made significant contribution to the development of Kannada language and literature (*Beary Adhyayana 2008*, Beary Adhyayana Kendra, Akhila Bharata Beary Parishat).

In Beary language , there are no aspirated sounds. Totally 10 vowel sounds are : **a, ā, i, ī, u, ū, e, ē, o, ō**, Special vowel sounds are : **ɨ** and **ɛ**. There are 23 consonant sounds including 6 nasals :

k, g, c, j, ʈ, ɖ, t, d, p, b, y, r, l, v, ś, s, h and nasals : **ṇ, ñ, ŋ, n, n', m**

In addition to these sounds , 3 special sounds are used : **kh, jh, ph** . Totally 36 alphabets .

Gender specific words are used clearly in Beary language. For feminine words the suffixes added are : **i, kār̥ti, gār̥ti**.

Example: beary (masc) – bearti (femi); *sorakāra* (Male worker)/masc - *sorakār̥ti* (Female worker)/femi; *pirānda* (Mad man)/masc - *pirānti* (Mad woman)/femi; *yajamāna* (Male owner)/masc - *yajamānti* (Female owner)/femi.

The plural suffixes in Beary language are : **ṇ, mār, ru**

Example: *dāda* (elder sister) – *dādaḍaṇa* (elder sisters) ; *caṇṇāyi* (friend)- *caṇṇāyimāru* (friends); *bālakkāra* (young person) - *bālakkāru* (young persons); *pōṇḍa* (he goes) - *pōṇḍāru* (they go).

For verb roots , suffixes like ‘ *bāṭu* ’ or ‘ *pāṭu* ’ are added to make the verb forms as causative.

Example: *ākū* (to do) - *ākūbāṭu* / *ākūpāṭu* (to make/cause someone to do)

ōḍu (to run) – *ōḍubāṭu* / *ōḍupāṭu* (to make/cause someone to run)

The suffixes ‘ *bāṭu* ’ and ‘ *pāṭu* ’ are commonly used with same usage .

The suffixes ‘ *ro* ’ and ‘ *ḍo* ’ , ‘ *re* ’ and ‘ *ḍe* ’ are also used with the same meaning .

Example: *celluḍo-celluro* (= saying); *ākūḍo-ākuro* (=doing).

pandurē-pandurē (=flicker); *piḍikurē-piḍikuḍē* (I hold/I catch)

There are a number of Arabic loan words in Beary language. In fact, such loan words enrich the growth of a language. However, when words are borrowed, their intonation and pronunciations change. Accommodating such changes is a power which is ingrained in every language.

In order to write such loan words of Arabic origin in Beary language , some special alphabets are created .They are : **kha, jha and pha**. They are pronounced differently from the pronunciation of ka, ja and pa respectively. This special sounds generally resemble the aspirated sounds of Kannada language in pronunciation. In addition to these sounds , a nasal sound unique to Beary language is used “ **n** ” . This is different from the nasal ‘ *n* ’.

Example : **n'ōkū** (see) ; **n'āvu** (tongue)

There are many words in Beary language which offer more than one meaning. This is true of other languages too. But what is noteworthy is that the number of such words in Beary language is considerably more than what may be seen in other languages. We have recognised this fact in the Lexicon. We have also noted the different meanings which the regional variants of the same word may offer. Besides, many words in English or Tulu have been taken there as they are as belonging to the Beary language. For example, *Computer, College* (English), *Bojja, Nema* (Tulu), *Upakara, Prayoga* (Kannada), etc.

Kodagu is a neighbouring district of what is historically identified with Tulunadu. But there seems to be nothing substantially common between the two barring shared boundaries. And yet, there are many words in Beary and Kodava languages only which share common meanings. Whether the origins of these words should be traced to Beary or to Kodava languages is a matter which can be clarified by serious search.

Since the influence of Islam on Bearys can be traced to Kerala and the Bearys depend much on Kerala for religious studies and instruction, there are many words in Beary language which are pronounced as Malayalam words. At the same time, one should note that many Bearys have migrated to others places and settled there. That has created new shades of meanings and pronunciations for the Beary words. This admixture of people and languages has ensured that for all the linguistic heritage that the Bearys claim, there are several regional and local variants therein. This kind of development is not strange or unusual because no living language is stagnant. There is ever a quiet give-and-take among all languages and cultures.

A language which can claim to have a history of over fifteen hundred years, Beary language has, however, remained a spoken language of a community, and in the absence of serious and systematic recording, this resulted in the weakening or eclipsing of its rich folklore. Along with it too has vanished the rich vocabulary of that language. Words which referred to many things and artefacts which the Bearys used, their jewellery and ornaments, their dresses, household articles, agricultural implements, food and drinks, and many other things which were once integral to the Beary ways of life have now all but vanished. The relentless forces of change which Time always seems to unleash have rendered these words *passé*. The growing hegemony of other languages, particularly of Malayalam, seductions of modernity, the bulldozing powers of urbanization, and priding oneself of the neglect of one's mother-tongue, have all orchestrated a process which has resulted in the loss of rich vocabulary of Beary language. In such a scenario, there is no exaggeration in saying that an attempt to highlight the opulence of Beary language and showcase its word- riches to the present generation and the next is nothing short of an adventure.

There was a strong desire among all the Bearys who loved their language and literature to bring out a dictionary of Beary language. In 1997 Bearys' Welfare Association of Bengaluru brought out, under the editorship of Dr. Wahab Doddamane, an 'English-Kannada-Beary Dictionary'. A good attempt, though it was, since the dictionary was meant to provide meanings of English words, it could not quite bring in many Beary words. In 2013 Dr A.M. Sridharan brought out, through Kerala Folklore Academy, a Dictionary of Beary Malayalam. Since that dictionary is in Malayalam language and the words therein are mostly confined to the Kasargod region of Kerala, it is of very limited use to the Kannada-knowing Bearys.

The Beary Lexicon has recognised the presence of considerable regional variations of Beary language, which is the result of the migration and spread of its speakers in different regions. The editors of the Lexicon have identified such variations in Mangalore and its vicinity, areas to the north of Mangalore like Udupi and Kundapura and the regions to the south of Mangalore like Kumble, Manjeshwara, Kasargod, Vittla, Puttur and Sullia and they have been accommodated in the Dictionary.

Since there is little by way of written literature in Beary language and its oral literature has largely suffered an eclipse, the task of retrieving the forgotten words in that language proved to be a daunting task. To meet the challenge the editors invited the supply of words from the members of the community. Though this communitarian participation was good and useful, it turned out that many words which were so supplied were repetitive and needed thorough sieving. The editors also went to all the books published in Beary language, the cassettes and CDs of Beary songs, the speeches made by different people in that language to prise out the words. Although many words

were in circulations, they were loosely used and some of their meanings could not be determined with any certainty. Their meanings in Kannada and English could not be captured easily. The regional variants of the words posed another set of challenges. The editors, therefore, had to approach many people for their opinion and counsel. For getting the right English translation of words, the editorial committee secured the help of Prof. B. Surendra Rao, a retired Professor of Mangalore University. Earlier Smt. Zohra Abbas Katipalla, an educationist and a member of the Academy, had for some time extended her assistance.

A name we should remember with gratitude is that of Late Dr. Susheela Upadhyaya. Though not belonging to the Beary community, her researches into the Beary language and culture was a major source of inspiration and they did much to notice and preserve the vanishing riches of Beary culture and folklore.

There were many challenges which the editorial committee had to face while putting together this dictionary. We discovered that if a word had one meaning in one area, it would have a different meaning in another. Words would mutate and their pronunciation also would vary from place to place. Although it was a quite a daunting task to track these changes, we did our best to do it. and documented about 20,000 Beary words. We cannot, though, assure you that we had met with success at every turn. We are aware that we have a long way to go; but we have done our bit. If this Lexicon is taken as a pointer to the richness and variety of Beary language and literature, we have not laboured in vain.

Since there are considerable regional variations in words, their meanings and pronunciations, it is hard to grasp what their original or right forms are. We have, therefore, respected these variants and given their meanings as obtaining in their respective locale. For those who do not read Kannada script, which Beary language habitually and comfortably uses, we have given the transliteration in Roman script and given the meanings in Kannada and English. We have given them also as explanatory notes, wherever necessary. We hope that it would help those who study comparative linguistics. In putting together this Lexicon we have consulted dictionaries in Kannada, English, Tulu and Konkani. We have also liberally dipped our hands into encyclopaedias, illustrated references to flora and fauna, to birds and fishes and a whole host of things that figure in our dictionary. Many people have supplied us with words that should figure in the Lexicon and we are indebted to all of them.

Any language is subject to relentless change, as is the society which uses it. It ensures that some words lose their use and circulation and even vanish out of sight. At the same time new words get recruited into its service. Linguists point out that the structure of the sentences may undergo changes. We have noted such an experience in Beary language and shown how the loss of words is substituted by an explanatory mode. For example, there is no word in Beary language to denote 'heart', or if had existed, it is now lost. And yet, communication was facilitated even without so important a word as this.

Bearys are part of a steady Diaspora, and they are building their lives in different parts of the world. Such people may not have a familiarity with Kannada script which Beary language has been traditionally using. In order to help them, as also to help non-Kannadigas, we have given the transliteration of words in Roman script. This will hopefully throw open Beary language and culture to the larger world and facilitate its study and use by people who are not brought up on the use of Kannada script.

In the making of the Beary Lexicon the role of the Sri B.A. Muhammad Hanif, the President of the Academy and the Chief Editor, is very significant. The editorial committee is appreciative of, and is indebted to, him for his continuous support. It is also thankful to the then Registrar Umarabba, who was with us from the beginning of the Dictionary work, present Registrar Chandrahassa Rai and all the Members of the Academy. It remembers with gratitude the help rendered by the members of the Advisory Committee like Prof. Viveka Rai, Prof. A.V. Navada, B.M. Hanif and Dr. U.P. Upadhyaya. We appreciate their sustained concern to see that the Lexicon should come out in a complete form. We also appreciate the work of Muhammad Iyaz Ullala, who was associated with the work of this Dictionary and was in charge of DTP.

The making of Beary Lexicon is one of the significant and ambitious projects of Karnataka Beary Sahitya Academy. In its scope and reach, it should be seen as the first in history. We hope to see it becoming the basis of a more comprehensive growth of Beary language and become an inspiration to a more enthusiastic and meaningful cultivation and appreciation of its literature.

No language can be likened to stagnant water. It grows with growing contacts and communication. Beary language is no exception. Since this Lexicon is the first of its kind, and since it had to be completed within a definite time-frame and with limited facilities, we are aware of its imperfections. The editorial committee is conscious of the fact that there may be many words which should go into this dictionary. There may be meanings other than what are given in it. The editors are aware that what is yet to be done may be a lot more than what has already been done. But they can be done in the subsequent editions of the Lexicon. We earnestly request scholars, linguists and litterateurs to use the Lexicon critically and suggest additions, deletions and changes to the Academy so that it can take up the project of its revision meaningfully.

B. M. Ichlangod

Editor

9902355744

ichlangodmedia@yahoo.in

B.A. Shamsuddin Madikeri

Co-Editor

9480083264

shamsmadikeri@yahoo.co.in

Abdul Rahman Kuthethoor

Co-Editor

9448192886